with the Soviet Union that was part of Delhi's China strategy as counterproductive to Washington's China strategy in Vietnam and even in India.

This chapter covers the period between 1963 and 1965, when both Delhi and Washington saw China as a major threat. For India, China was enemy number one. In the US, Kennedy and others believed, according to Arthur Schlesinger, that one could talk to Moscow, but Beijing was the "long-term danger to peace."[1] This sense did not dissipate when Lyndon Johnson became president in November 1963 and as US involvement in Vietnam increased.

Differences, however, appeared between American and Indian threat perceptions. The US saw China as a medium- to long-term threat to India. Furthermore, while American officials did not rule out the external security threat to India, they, sounding like Nehru had in the early 1950s, worried more about the internal challenge to India that China posed. There was now little hope for India's possibilities and much fear about its vulnerabilities. Since policymakers worried that an internal collapse was more likely to bring this domino down, their prescription was development-heavy and defense-light spending for India. This would also demonstrate to Congress that Delhi was making a serious effort to meet the China challenge not just at its border but also within. On the defense front, they believed the US could provide implicit assurance and some explicit assistance. Furthermore, India could ease its defense problem—and thus the burden on its budget—by making Pakistan part of its China solution.

Indian policymakers, on the other hand, believed that they could not afford to underestimate the immediacy or the extent of the China threat again. Development continued to be a key objective, but defense spending could no longer be ignored at its expense. And lessons learned about external benefactors during the war and after it shaped India's approach to strengthening its defense capabilities. The lack of Soviet dependability and American efforts to get India to settle with Pakistan, which Delhi saw as part of its China problem, reinforced policymakers' sense that external benefactors were unreliable and that dependence came with unwelcome demands. This meant diversifying dependence by maintaining multiple partners and suppliers and reducing dependence to the extent possible. And to build an independent capability and to deal with increased domestic